

Early-Stage Founder Fundamentals Checklist

Find the operating gaps that are easy to miss early and expensive to repair once growth accelerates.

1. Pricing and margin

- ☐ Does your pricing cover your real costs, including fulfilment, fees, waste and your time?
- ☐ Have you tested a price change, or set the price once and left it?
- ☐ Do you know the margin on your best-seller compared with your most-promoted item?

2. Product and range

- ☐ Has the range grown without anyone testing what customers actually buy and repeat?
- ☐ Do you know your top three performers, and are you giving them enough visibility?
- ☐ Is anything still in the range through habit rather than evidence?

3. Stock and operations

- ☐ Are you managing stock through a repeatable system, or mainly by feel?
- ☐ Do you repeatedly overorder or run out of the same items?
- ☐ Could someone else run the ordering process accurately without you?

4. Brand consistency

- ☐ Does the brand look and feel consistent across social, packaging, site and in-person experience?
- ☐ Is one person accountable for that consistency, or does it drift between channels?
- ☐ Would a new customer recognise the same business across two different touchpoints?

HOW TO USE YOUR ANSWERS

Mark every No or Not sure. Start with pricing, margin and stock gaps because they affect every acquisition and growth decision that follows.



Faisal Mahmud

FRACTIONAL MARKETING DIRECTOR

Built Pako Taco from concept to an award-winning hospitality brand, handling these fundamentals first-hand.

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